The Fitness Frame: Partnership & Service Options

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How to read this

You asked what it would look like to team up with someone who handles the marketing while you create the content. This document answers that from the scary end of the scale down to the simple end.

1. **Three tiers of service**, from a fractional CMO for the next few years down to "just run my ads."
2. **Four ways to structure the deal:** straight fee, fee plus commission, commission only, and the stair-step into equity we talked about.
3. **An à la carte menu**, so you can see what each piece is worth on its own.
4. **How to shop it**, so the next five to ten conversations you have give you real comparisons.

Treat it as a proposal from us, or treat it as reference material while you shop. Both are fine. Prices assume your ad spend is paid directly to Google and Meta, separate from our fees.

The three tiers

Tier 3: The Whole Enchilada (fractional CMO, 2 to 4 years)

The version where you build a big company. You stay the face, the product guy and the closer. We run marketing like an in-house department.

Everything in Tier 2, plus:

- **Fractional Chief Marketing Officer:** I lead strategy, set the quarterly plan, and sit in on the big decisions.
- **Institution sales program:** one-pagers, target lists and follow-up sequences for PT clinics, aquatic centers, YMCAs and 55+ communities, built to support your outside sales.
- **Amazon launch and management** for the Frame and the accessories.
- **PR and TV readiness:** press kit, story angles, and Shark Tank and QVC/HSN submission packages.
- **Website rebuild** on a faster, modern design.

- **Quarterly market research:** a cheap test before any big channel bet, so there's never another Pinch A Penny year.
- **Monthly executive report:** sales by channel, cost per sale, what's next.

Investment: $7,500 setup, then $6,500/month, 12-month minimum.

Suggested ad spend: $2,000 to $5,000/month.

Tier 2: The Growth Engine (my recommendation for where you are)

You film. We do everything else, every week.

- **Website management and search:** product updates, ongoing SEO, Google Business Profile, monthly reporting (our Spark Ecommerce Care Growth plan).
- **Meta and Google ads management:** retargeting first, then new audiences.
- **Social media management** on Instagram, Facebook and TikTok: posting, captions, replies.
- **YouTube:** 4 long videos and 12 Shorts a month, edited from your footage.
- **Email:** the welcome series plus 2 campaigns a month.
- **Micro-influencer program:** 5 to 10 creators a quarter on a gift-plus-commission deal, with content rights secured.

Investment: $1,500 setup, then $3,250/month, 6-month minimum.

Suggested ad spend: $1,000 to $2,500/month.

Tier 1: The Foundation (someone handling my ads)

The simple version. We fix the plumbing and run your ads. You keep doing the content and social yourself.

- **Level 1 setup, done for you:** tracking (Move 1), the $699 page upgrade (Move 2), and the storefront cleanup and accessibility basics (Move 4) from your roadmap.
- **Spark Ecommerce Care Growth** ($297/month): site management, search visibility, Google Business Profile, reporting, and 4 hours a month of hands-on help.
- **Meta ads management** ($350/month): retargeting your site visitors and video viewers.

Investment: $950 setup, then $647/month, month-to-month.

Suggested ad spend: $500 to $1,000/month.

Guarantee: the Care Growth plan carries our 90-day money-back guarantee.

Four ways to structure the deal

These are illustrations to start the conversation, not a contract. Run every one past your SCORE mentor, and have an attorney paper anything involving equity.

A. Straight fee

You pay the tier price. You keep 100% of the upside and the company.

- **Best when:** you have the cash flow and want to stay the sole owner.
- **Watch for:** make sure the partner reports results monthly and that every account is owned in your name.

B. Reduced fee plus commission per Frame

The partner takes a lower monthly fee in exchange for a cut of each Frame they can prove they sold (through a tracked link, code or ad). Their cut grows as volume grows.

Example on Tier 2:

- Monthly fee drops from $3,250 to $1,950.
- $60 per attributed Frame for the first 20 each month.
- $75 per Frame for 21 to 50.
- $90 per Frame above 50.

What it looks like at 30 attributed Frames a month:

- Revenue: 30 × $699 = $20,970
- Commission: (20 × $60) + (10 × $75) = $1,950
- Total partner cost: $1,950 fee + $1,950 commission = $3,900, about 19% of that revenue.
- **Best when:** you want the partner to have skin in the game without giving up ownership.
- **Watch for:** this only works if tracking is solid. That's why Move 1 of your roadmap comes first.

C. Commission only

No monthly fee. The partner earns only on sales, typically 15% to 25% of attributed revenue.

- **Best when:** a partner believes in the product enough to carry all the risk.
- **Watch for:** they'll usually ask for exclusivity and for 12 to 18 months of financials before they say yes, and they'll favor quick sales over brand building. This is the "they want to see a pulse first" conversation from our call.

D. The stair-step into equity (what we talked about)

Start small, prove it, then earn ownership in steps.

Stage	Timing	Structure	Unlocks when
Trial	Months 1 to 3	Option B (fee + commission)	Tracking live, reporting monthly, first sales attributed
Proving	Months 4 to 6	Option B with a higher commission tier	Averaging an agreed target, e.g. 25 attributed Frames a month
Partner	Month 7+	An equity grant, e.g. 2%, vesting over 4 years with a 1-year cliff	Sustaining the target for 3 straight months
Growth	Year 2+	Further grants at bigger milestones, capped (e.g. 5% total)	e.g. 50+ Frames a month, a retail or TV deal

Protections to build in:

- The intellectual property stays in your company.
- Unvested equity goes away if the partner leaves or misses targets.
- You keep a right to buy back vested shares.
- Every ad, social and email account is owned by the company, not the partner.
- If the company is sold, everyone's vesting speeds up, so the partner is motivated to build toward an exit.

- **Best when:** you want someone thinking like an owner for the next 2 to 4 years, the way we described the Famous Amos and Colonel Sanders model.
- **Watch for:** equity is the most expensive currency you have. Spend it only after someone has proven themselves.

À la carte menu

If you'd rather pick pieces than a tier, here's what each one costs on its own.

Service	Price
Tracking install: Meta Pixel + Conversions API, Google Ads tag, GA4 sales events checked	$450 one-time
$699 product page upgrade: layout, trust block, video placement, specs, payment-plan setup	$650 one-time
Accessibility quick-fix pass: the four basics plus contrast	$450 one-time
Homepage cleanup: headline, COVID slide out, page descriptions, share image, speed trim	$500 one-time
Email capture + 5-email welcome series in HubSpot	$900 one-time
15-Minute Launchpad polish: move names on screen, voiceover edit	$350 one-time
Affiliate program setup: tracking, creator codes, terms template	$600 one-time
YouTube channel setup: branding, playlists, descriptions	$425 one-time
Video editing: long-form YouTube video	$150 per video
Video editing: pack of 10 Shorts	$300 per pack
Social media setup: profiles, branding, content pillars	$425 one-time
Social media management, starter: 2 to 3 posts a week	$585/month
Social media management: 3 platforms, regular posting	$1,250/month

Service	Price
Meta ads: setup, then management (up to $5,000/month spend)	$350 + $350/month
Google ads: setup, then management (up to $5,000/month spend)	$350 + $350/month
SEO, one-time optimization	$900 one-time
SEO, monthly	$750/month
Spark Ecommerce Care Growth (site management, search, reporting)	$297/month
Website rebuild, modern WooCommerce store	from $2,500
Influencer event, small (5 to 10 creators)	$1,000 per event
Influencer event, large (10 to 25 creators)	$2,250 per event
Market research sprint: test one channel in 30 days (ad spend separate)	$1,200
Strategy session	$120/hour

How to shop this

I meant it on the call: have five to ten more of these conversations before you decide. Here's how to get real comparisons instead of sales pitches.

The pitch to give each firm, in your words:

"I'm Tony Salomone. I invented The Fitness Frame, a patented amphibious training frame for land and water, $699, aimed at baby boomers. I create the content. I'm looking for a marketing partner to handle digital, ads, social, email and creators. I've had a few quotes. Tell

me what you'd do in the first 90 days, what it costs, and whether you'd consider a fee-plus-commission or equity arrangement."

Questions to ask every one of them:

1. What would you do first, and why?
2. What exactly will I see every month, and what numbers will you be accountable for?
3. Who owns the ad accounts, the pixel, the email list and the content if we part ways? (The answer should be: you do.)
4. Would you take a lower fee for a commission per unit? At what numbers?
5. Have you ever worked for equity? How did it vest?
6. Who on your team actually does the work?
7. Can I talk to a client who sells a physical product?

Then line their answers up against this document.

Next step

Separate from all of this, you offered to bring a Frame to Lakeland for a joint workout. We'll turn that session into a content shoot for you: we'll film it, walk you through building a content library in your Google Drive, and use it to freshen up your socials.

Which is more useful to start: the roadmap moves on your own, or a Tier 1 setup so the plumbing gets done this month?

Grant Sparks

Marketing Partnerships with Spark

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